

March

19

1279

Battle of Yamen

In China, the Song Dynasty ended after the Battle of Yamen, a clash at sea in which the invading Mongol Yuan navy defeated the Song navy. Yuan emperor Kublai Khan took power.



Also on this day

1982 Argentinian workers landed on the British-controlled Falkland Islands and raised their national flag, triggering a 10-week war between the two countries.

2018 The last surviving male northern white rhinoceros, called Sudan, died of old age in Kenya.

2019 US mathematician Karen Uhlenbeck became the first woman to win the Norwegian Abel Prize for her pioneering work.

Sagrada Família

Bishop Urquinaona laid the first stone of the Sagrada Família, a huge cathedral in Barcelona, Spain. This unique building designed by the famous Catalan architect Antoni Gaudí is still being built almost 150 years later.

1882

1842

Empty seats

The French play *Les Ressources de Quinola* opened to an almost empty theatre because the writer Honoré de Balzac – in a publicity stunt gone wrong – had declared the show was already a sellout.



Born this day

1848 Wyatt Earp, legendary figure in the Wild West. He blazed his own trail across the USA, working as a gunfighter, gambler, miner, law officer, and saloonkeeper.

